HEARTHWORK

Christmas Countdown Calendar for Kid

Simple printables for families who want rhythm, not chaos.

Inside this kit:

- December 1 to 25 color-in countdown calendar
- Christmas tree ornament countdown
- Cut-out paper chain countdown (25 links)
- 25 Christmas countdown activity ideas
- Week-by-week December family countdown planner
- Countdown tips by age (2 to 12)

Print on US Letter at 100% scale. Black and gray ink friendly.
Tip: slip pages into a dry-erase sleeve to reuse every week.

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December Color-In Countdown

Color one circle each day from December 1 to Christmas. Advent 2026 begins Nov 29; this Dec 1 to 25 calendar mat

1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25

This December we are looking forward to:

Christmas Tree Ornament Countdown

Print, color the tree spaces, then sticker or color one ornament circle a day. Hang it at kid height.

How to use it

- Hang the page on the fridge or by the tree.
- Each day, color one numbered circle or add a sticker.
- Let the youngest kids pick the next ornament to mark.

1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25

Our tree countdown rule (one a day, no skipping ahead):

Paper Chain Countdown

Cut apart on the dashed lines, color, and loop into a chain. Tear off one link each night from Dec 1 to Christmas.

Dec 1 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**24**	**Dec 14** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**11**
Dec 2 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**23**	**Dec 15** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**10**
Dec 3 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**22**	**Dec 16** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**9**
Dec 4 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**21**	**Dec 17** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**8**
Dec 5 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**20**	**Dec 18** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**7**
Dec 6 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**19**	**Dec 19** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**6**
Dec 7 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**18**	**Dec 20** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**5**
Dec 8 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**17**	**Dec 21** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**4**
Dec 9 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**16**	**Dec 22** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**3**
Dec 10 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**15**	**Dec 23** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**2**
Dec 11 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**14**	**Dec 24** Christmas countdown	more sleep to Christmas	**1**
Dec 12 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**13**	**Dec 25** Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**0**
Dec 13 Christmas countdown	more sleeps to Christmas	**12**			

25 Christmas Countdown Activities

Check the ones you want to try. Keep most of them under 20 minutes.

- [ ] Color today's countdown circle
- [ ] Tear one paper chain link
- [ ] Add one ornament to the tree
- [ ] Read a Christmas picture book
- [ ] Sing one carol at bedtime
- [ ] Make hot cocoa together
- [ ] Cut paper snowflakes
- [ ] Write a card to a grandparent
- [ ] Bake one tray of cookies
- [ ] Drive to see Christmas lights
- [ ] Act out the nativity story
- [ ] Make a gift for a sibling
- [ ] Wrap one present together
- [ ] Give away one outgrown toy
- [ ] Eat dinner by candlelight
- [ ] String a popcorn garland
- [ ] Make paper stars for a window
- [ ] Fill a bag for the food bank
- [ ] Build a blanket fort and read
- [ ] Pray for one friend tonight
- [ ] Learn a carol by heart
- [ ] Make salt dough ornaments
- [ ] Have a pajama breakfast
- [ ] Visit or call a relative
- [ ] Set out the nativity pieces

Our own countdown ideas

December Week-by-Week Planner

Plan one special countdown moment per day. Print a fresh copy each week.

Day	Countdown moment	Who leads	Done
Mon			
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			

This week we will give or serve by:

Notes for next week

Countdown Tips by Age

Simple beats fancy. A short daily mark is enough.

- [ ] Ages 2 to 5: color the big circles, tear the chain link, and stick one ornament. Keep the mark under a minute.
- [ ] Ages 6 to 8: let them lead the countdown mark, pick one activity from the list, and help hang the chain.
- [ ] Ages 9 to 12: put them in charge of the planner for one week and have them choose the family giving idea.
- [ ] All ages: do the mark at the same time every day, like right after dinner, so it becomes a habit.
- [ ] Missed a day? Color today's circle and keep going. No catching up.
- [ ] Tip: pair this free countdown with a fuller Advent rhythm if you want readings and prayers through the season.

What we want this Christmas season to feel like